

2026 INTERVIEW CRACKING PLAN

12-week roadmap for strong software / full-stack roles

Recommended positioning: Full-Stack Developer + AI capability + AI/DS background

Target roles

Primary	SDE-1, Junior Full-Stack Developer, React Developer, Node.js Developer
Secondary	Backend Developer, AI-enabled Full-Stack Developer
Approach	Apply across product companies, strong IT/service firms, and startups - do not depend only on Tier-1 companies.

Core preparation stack

Area	Priority
DSA	★★★★★
JavaScript + React	★★★★★
Node.js + Backend	★★★★★
SQL + DBMS	★★★★☆
CS Fundamentals	★★★★☆
Projects + Resume + Interview	★★★★★

PHASE 1 - Aug 18 to Sep 7

Fix fundamentals: DSA: arrays, strings, hashing, two pointers, sliding window, sorting, binary search; then linked list, stack, queue, recursion/backtracking, trees, BST, heap. Focus on patterns, not memorization.

PHASE 2 - Sep 8 to Sep 28

JavaScript + React: JavaScript: scope, hoisting, closures, promises, async/await, event loop, debouncing/throttling, ES6+. React: components, props/state, hooks, routing, forms, API integration, authentication, protected routes, performance, state management.

PHASE 3 - Sep 29 to Oct 19

Backend + Database: Node/Express: middleware, REST APIs, JWT, cookies, CORS, validation, uploads, pagination, rate limiting, error handling and security. PostgreSQL: joins, CTEs, window functions, indexes, transactions, normalization and ACID.

PHASE 4 - Oct 20 to Nov 2

CS Fundamentals: OOP, DBMS, OS and Computer Networks. Be ready to explain concepts clearly rather than memorize textbook definitions.

PHASE 5 - Nov 3 to Nov 16

Upgrade projects: Turn two existing projects into interview-ready portfolio pieces. Prioritize architecture, authentication, roles, APIs, data model, deployment and measurable features.

PHASE 6 - Nov 17 onward

Mock interview mode: Shift from learning to execution: DSA sets, technical Q&A, project explanation, SQL practice, CS revision, referrals and applications.

Daily schedule

Time	Focus
7:00	Wake up
7:30-9:00	DSA
Work hours	Job/work
Breaks	15-20 min SQL or CS revision
6:30-8:30	React / Node / Backend
8:30	Dinner
9:00-10:00	Project work
10:00-10:30	Interview questions
10:30-11:00	Applications + referrals
11:00-11:30	English / interview speaking
11:30	Sleep

DSA target: 120-150 quality problems

Topic	Target
Arrays	15
Strings	10
Hashing	10
Two pointers	8
Sliding window	8
Binary search	10
Linked List	10
Stack / Queue	10
Recursion / Backtracking	8
Trees	15
Heap	8
Graphs	12
Dynamic Programming	10

Rule: understanding 130 patterns is better than collecting 500 random questions.

Project strategy

Project 1 - Kiwago: Make it your flagship full-stack project. Be ready to explain React, Node/Express, PostgreSQL, authentication, role-based access, restaurant/menu management, orders, payments, admin, rider flows, validation, error handling and deployment.

Project 2 - AI Resume Analyzer: Build a practical AI + full-stack application. Example flow: resume upload -> skill extraction -> job-description matching -> match score -> missing skills -> interview questions -> improvement suggestions. Suggested stack: React, Node.js, PostgreSQL, Python/FastAPI, LLM API.

Interview topics you must explain without Googling

JavaScript: closures, event loop, promises, async/await, debounce/throttle, map/filter/reduce

React: rendering, keys, hooks, useMemo vs useCallback, state management, performance

Node.js: concurrency model, middleware, JWT authentication, API design, CORS, security

SQL: second-highest salary, joins, indexes, CTEs, window functions, normalization, ACID

CS fundamentals: OOP, DBMS, OS processes/threads/deadlocks, TCP/UDP, HTTP/HTTPS, DNS, REST, cookies, JWT

System design: URL shortener, food delivery system, chat app, e-commerce backend

Resume + GitHub + application strategy

Resume: Keep it to one page. Lead with Software Engineer / Full-Stack Developer / AI & Data Science positioning. Prioritize measurable project impact and relevant technologies.

GitHub: Keep 2 flagship projects, a DSA repository, and one smaller project visible. Each major repo should have a strong README with problem, features, architecture, tech stack, screenshots, setup, API documentation and live demo where possible.

Applications: Aim for 5-10 targeted applications per day and around 5 meaningful referral attempts per day. Apply across product companies, strong service companies and startups.

Interview communication: Practice speaking answers out loud. Technical knowledge only converts to offers when you can explain decisions, trade-offs, debugging steps and project architecture clearly.

90-day success checklist

- 120-150 DSA problems completed and understood
- 2 strong portfolio projects, including 1 AI-integrated project
- Strong React + Node.js + PostgreSQL fundamentals
- SQL interview readiness
- OOP + DBMS + OS + Computer Networks interview readiness
- One-page resume and professional GitHub
- 100+ targeted applications
- 30+ referral attempts
- 10+ mock interviews
- Ability to explain every major project without notes

Final positioning

Full-Stack Developer with AI capability. Prioritize JavaScript, React, Node.js, PostgreSQL, DSA, CS fundamentals, projects and interview communication. Your AI/DS degree becomes a differentiator when it is combined with strong software-engineering execution.

Prepared for Aditya - August 2026